

STEADY PRESS

Chronic Pain & Symptom Journal

Ninety days of structured tracking for pain, symptoms, sleep, mood and treatment — built to be handed to a specialist.

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FORMAT

A4

PAGES

16

USE

Print as many copies as you need

THE ROUTINE

- ☐ Complete the daily log every evening
- ☐ Log flares the moment they start, not afterwards
- ☐ Update the body map every two weeks
- ☐ Shade the 90-day grid daily
- ☐ Weekly review each Sunday, monthly review at month end
- ☐ Take the summary page to every appointment

THE SCALE YOU WILL USE

NO PAIN 0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 WORST IMAGINABLE

WHAT THE NUMBERS MEAN

- 1 Noticeable, easy to ignore 3 Annoying, does not stop you 5 Hard to concentrate through 7 Limits what you can do
- 9 Unable to function

Ninety days is the horizon most specialists want. Shorter than that and a slow trend is indistinguishable from a bad fortnight.

This is a record-keeping tool, not medical advice. Bring it to a professional rather than using it to self-diagnose.

WHAT I WANT TO GET OUT OF THIS

My history in one page

Write this once. It saves repeating your story at every new appointment.

SYMPTOMS BEGAN

DIAGNOSED?

DIAGNOSIS

HOW IT STARTED

WHAT HAS BEEN TRIED SO FAR

WHEN	TREATMENT / PROFESSIONAL	OUTCOME

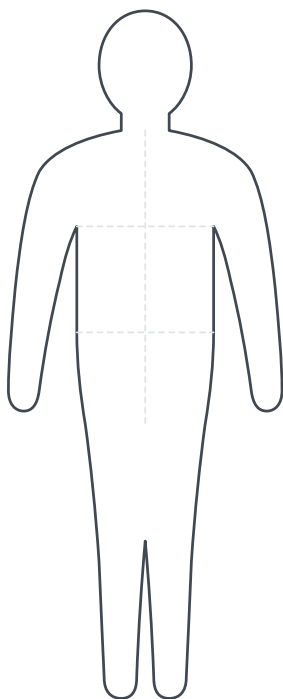
TESTS AND RESULTS

DATE	TEST	RESULT

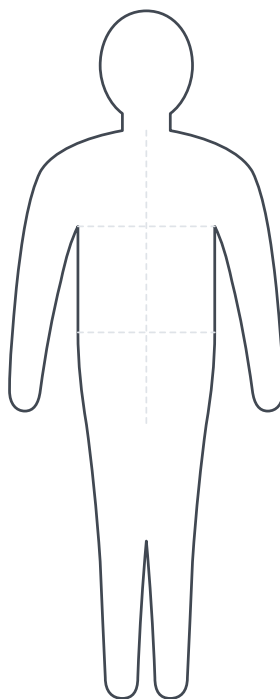
Where it hurts

DATE _____

OVERALL LEVEL (0-10)



FRONT



[BACK](#)

MARKING KEY write the letter on the spot that hurts

A Aching / dull **S** Sharp / stabbing **B** Burning **T** Tingling / numb **R** Radiating (draw an arrow) **St** Stiff / restricted

CHANGES SINCE LAST MAP

Daily log

DATE _____

SLEEP QUALITY /10

MOOD /10

A horizontal scale from 0 to 10. The number 5 is highlighted with a blue border. Below the scale, the word 'NONE' is on the left and 'WORST' is on the right.

Response Category	Count
NONE	0
1	1
2	2
3	3
4	4
5	5
6	6
7	7
8	8
9	9
WORST	10

[illegible]

☐ Got out of the house	☐ Worked a full day	☐ Exercised or stretched
☐ Ate properly	☐ Saw someone	☐ Slept through
☐ Took meds as planned	☐ Did my exercises	☐ Rested deliberately

Flare log

A flare is worth more data than a normal day. Fill this in while it is happening.

DATE	STARTED AT	ENDED	PEAK (0–10)
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WHAT I WAS DOING BEFOREHAND

HOW IT FELT AND WHERE

WHAT I DID ABOUT IT

TIME	ACTION TAKEN	EFFECT
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IN HINDSIGHT, THE LIKELY CAUSE

90-day grid

START DATE _____ END DATE _____

END DATE

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15
16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	29	30
31	32	33	34	35	36	37	38	39	40	41	42	43	44	45
46	47	48	49	50	51	52	53	54	55	56	57	58	59	60
61	62	63	64	65	66	67	68	69	70	71	72	73	74	75
76	77	78	79	80	81	82	83	84	85	86	87	88	89	90

— 0-2 · good day / 3-4 · manageable x 5-6 · difficult # 7-10 · flare • Treatment changed

Trigger tracker

LOGGED TRIGGERS

DATE	SUSPECTED TRIGGER	DELAY BEFORE PAIN	SEVERITY	CONFIDENT?

CONFIRMED TRIGGERS SO FAR

MEDICATION	DOSE	TIMES PER DAY	STARTED	PRESCRIBED BY

[illegible]

Appointments & therapies

LOG

DATE	PROFESSIONAL	WHAT WAS DONE	ADVICE GIVEN	COST

NEXT STEPS AGREED

EVERY SUNDAY

Weekly review

Ten minutes looking back is where the pattern actually shows up.

WEEK OF

BEST DAY

WORST DAY

THE WEEK AT A GLANCE

DAY

AVG PAIN

SLEEP

NOTABLE

WHAT MADE IT BETTER

WHAT MADE IT WORSE

ONE THING TO CHANGE NEXT WEEK

Monthly review

The only page where you are allowed to zoom out and judge whether anything is actually working.

MONTH

GOOD DAYS

BAD DAYS

AVERAGE PAIN THIS MONTH

0

1

2

3

4

5

6

7

8

9

10

NONE

WORST

BETTER THAN LAST MONTH

WORSE THAN LAST MONTH

TREATMENTS TO KEEP

TREATMENTS TO STOP OR QUESTION

WHAT I WILL RAISE AT MY NEXT APPOINTMENT

APPOINTMENT

Doctor visit prep

Fill this in the day before. Most appointments are short — walking in with this changes what you get out of it.

DATE OF VISIT

SEEING

IN ONE SENTENCE, WHAT IS THE PROBLEM?

THE FACTS

QUESTION

YOUR ANSWER

HAVE YOU ALREADY TRIED

☐ Rest

☐ Heat

☐ Ice

☐ Stretching

☐ Painkillers

☐ Physio

☐ Massage

☐ New pillow

☐ Desk changes

QUESTIONS I WANT ANSWERED

WHAT WAS DECIDED

Summary sheet

Copy the highlights here and hand this single page over. Nobody reads ninety pages.

NAME

PERIOD COVERED

DATE

THE NUMBERS

MEASURE

VALUE

MAIN SYMPTOMS, IN ORDER OF IMPACT

CONFIRMED TRIGGERS

WHAT HAS HELPED

WHAT HAS NOT

Anything the structured pages did not capture.

Before you start

These pages are a personal record-keeping tool. They are not a medical device, they do not diagnose anything, and nothing here is medical advice.

Tracking is useful because it turns vague memory into specifics you can hand to a professional: when it started, what makes it worse, what you already tried. It is not a substitute for seeing one.

See a qualified healthcare professional about any new, severe, or worsening symptom. Seek urgent care for chest pain, numbness or weakness in a limb, loss of bladder or bowel control, severe headache of sudden onset, pain following an accident, fever with neck stiffness, or any symptom that frightens you.

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